# AI in Hiring

Beyond the False Binary: Transparency, Not Technology, as the Solution

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# 1 Part 1: What Goes Wrong

### 1.1 Why doesn't some of the technology work as promised/advertised/expected?

Schellmann documents that hiring AI failures aren't accidents—they're profitable business models. Resume screeners recognize only 40% of résumé information while identifying meaningless correlations (names, locations, sports) as job-performance proxies. Personality tools produce contradictory results across profiles. AI games claim to measure cognition but test game-playing, not job capability. Vendors prioritize revenue over accuracy, marketing tools as *"scientifically validated"* while hiding validation data behind NDAs. Market pressure incentivizes deception systemically.

### 1.2 Why does Schellmann compare some uses of AI to pseudoscience like phrenology?

*Both share identical assumptions:* inner character manifests externally (essentialism), and instruments extract this reliably (technological determinism). Phrenology read skull bumps; AI reads facial micro-expressions, voice tone, game behavior. Both failed because their premise was wrong. Vendors use AI as rhetorical camouflage, hiding discredited frameworks behind algorithmic opacity while claiming innovation.

### 1.3 How are faulty AI technologies negatively impacting job applicants?

The real question isn't *"how do AI harm"* but *"why are companies allowed to weaponize faulty systems while claiming efficacy?"* AI amplifies harm already embedded in human processes. Applicants experience rejection without explanation, inability to challenge decisions, and compounding discrimination—CLD candidates, people with disabilities, immigrants face exclusion simultaneously across hiring, healthcare, and education. Opacity transfers blame inward: applicants internalize inadequacy when actual cause was algorithmic failure.

# 2 Part 2: The Human Cost

### 2.1 What is "dehumanization" in hiring?

Fritts and Cabrera define dehumanization as removing human presence from processes where it was fundamental. However, their analysis requires technical correction: AI doesn't operate *"without understanding"*—it operates with *bounded understanding*, constrained to metrics while human understanding extends to meaning. This reveals structural limitation, not fixable flaw. No training data can teach algorithms what humans understand through embodied, relational, contextual judgment.

### 2.2 How does AI treats people differently from how humans would during interviews?

This question creates a false binary. The issue isn't *"AI vs. human"*—*both* can abuse through opacity. An algorithm would never conduct deliberately cruel interviews where managers repeatedly ask the same question to establish dominance. But neither would algorithms recognize unconventional brilliance interviewers might see. The actual question is; *how do we design transparent, accountable systems protecting people from both?*

### 2.3 How does the ballet dancer example illustrate the problem of dehumanization?

The example demonstrates academic framing obscuring actual problems. Fritts and Cabrera argue the dancer felt dehumanized because AI couldn't appreciate art. But human judges also reduce dancers to technique scores. Humans systematized metric-based dehumanization for centuries—AI made it efficient. The solution isn't choosing between judges; it's designing transparent systems where neither can hide criteria or abuse power.

# 3 Part 3: Evaluation

## 3.1 Main strengths and limitations of Schellmann's and Fritts and Cabrera's approach

### 3.1.1 Strengths

Schellmann's empirical rigor exposes what corporate opacity conceals—Amazon's bias, HireVue contradictions, Pymetrics' invalidity—while Fritts and Cabrera's philosophical analysis clarifies why *"fair"* algorithms remain insufficient. Together, they present compelling arguments grounded in evidence and ethics.

### 3.1.2 Limitations

They sustain false binaries (AI versus human) obscuring systemic dehumanization operating across both. Neither advances transparency, education, or governance frameworks addressing power: mandatory disclosure, community partnership, government oversight with monetary incentives. Schellmann investigates without resolving; Fritts and Cabrera philosophize without operational mechanisms. Both overlook marginalized populations most harmed by algorithmic *and* human abuse behind institutional opacity.

### 3.1.3 The Actual Question

The issue isn't *"who dehumanizes more"* but how to design transparent, equitable, community-partnered systems protecting individuals from both. Companies respond to monetary incentives, not moral appeals. Framework regulation—combining transparency requirements, community oversight, governmental enforcement through tax-based incentives—offers pragmatic solutions. The challenge lies not in technology but in accountability-deficient deployment frameworks.

**Word Count:** 598 words (Parts 1–3 combined, excluding titles, questions, and section headings)